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launch checks
before you announce.

A normal-user pass for SaaS founders: first contact, core journey, and launch truth.

FIRST CONTACT

CORE JOURNEY

LAUNCH TRUTH

Built for public paths. No credentials. No security claims.

FIRST CONTACT

Start like a stranger.

The first screen should explain the product and offer one honest next step.

01

Value is obvious in five seconds

Load the homepage cold. Can someone state who it is for, what it does, and why it matters without scrolling?

FAILURE SIGNAL

The description fits several unrelated products.

02

Headline matches the product

Compare the headline with the current product screen, release, or documented workflow.

FAILURE SIGNAL

Launch copy describes an older product or an unavailable feature.

03

Primary action is unambiguous

Follow the dominant first-screen button. Its label should predict the destination and next step.

FAILURE SIGNAL

Get started opens a demo, waitlist, generic page, or dead anchor.

04

Mobile first screen holds

Test a 390-pixel viewport. Check headline, main action, navigation, consent layers, and overflow.

FAILURE SIGNAL

The action is clipped, covered, or pushed below avoidable chrome.

CORE JOURNEY

Can a new visitor reach value?

A dashboard is not the outcome. Complete the first meaningful public journey.

05

Sign up or log in works

Use the public entry point. Note redirects, validation, loading states, and confirmation.

FAILURE SIGNAL

A successful action returns to the same state with no explanation.

06

First key action succeeds

Complete the one safe action that demonstrates the product's promised value.

FAILURE SIGNAL

The visitor arrives but cannot find or finish the first meaningful task.

07

Recovery path is clear

Trigger one ordinary validation error or empty result. The message should explain the next step.

FAILURE SIGNAL

A generic error, silent reset, or disabled action strands the visitor.

08

Empty states guide forward

Inspect new-account, no-result, and zero-item states that appear naturally.

FAILURE SIGNAL

The page names what is missing but offers no action or example.

LAUNCH TRUTH

Does the public promise match?

Price, scope, status, and accessibility should agree across the surfaces a buyer sees.

09

Pricing path is consistent

Compare homepage, pricing, checkout, FAQ, and terms for price, billing, limits, trial, and cancellation.

FAILURE SIGNAL

A buyer cannot tell which public promise governs the purchase.

10

Launch promise matches the build

Check the launch post or listing against the current homepage and reachable product paths.

FAILURE SIGNAL

Names, scope, integrations, or availability drift between surfaces.

11

Confirmations explain next steps

After signup, purchase, or submission, look for status, ownership, timing, and the next action.

FAILURE SIGNAL

Success looks identical to failure or creates unexplained waiting.

12

Obvious accessibility blockers are absent

Keyboard through the journey, zoom to 200%, inspect labels, and check meaningful image alternatives.

FAILURE SIGNAL

Focus disappears, controls have no name, or content becomes unreachable.

METHOD

Run it like a buyer, not the builder.

Four constraints make the checklist useful instead of theatrical.

- 01

Go private

Open a private browser window. Start from the public URL, not an internal shortcut.
- 02

Use two widths

Test desktop and a common phone width. A 390-pixel viewport catches avoidable mobile blockers.
- 03

Use safe data

Take only ordinary public actions. Never share credentials, private URLs, secrets, or customer data.
- 04

Record the result

Keep the URL, UTC time, viewport, step number, expected result, observed result, and screenshot.
- Rule of thumb

If another person cannot reproduce it, it is not ready for the issue list.

EVIDENCE

A finding without evidence is an opinion.

Capture enough context for the builder to reproduce the moment.

ISSUE 03 / PUBLIC PRICING JOURNEY

P1

Checkout price contradicts the pricing page

PUBLIC URL	example.com/pricing
UTC TIME	2026-08-02 10:24 UTC
VIEWPORT	390 x 844 pixels
STEP	Pricing page -> monthly plan -> checkout
EXPECTED	\$29 per month, billed monthly
OBSERVED	\$39 charge at checkout with no explanation

+ one screenshot

Show the visible state, not a cropped fragment with no location or context.

PRIORITY

Fix blockers before polishing friction.

Three labels are enough when they describe impact, not drama.

P0	Launch journey blocked A visitor cannot complete the promised public journey. Examples: dead signup, checkout cannot complete, primary action fails.
P1	Material conversion friction The journey works, but trust, clarity, or progress is materially damaged. Examples: price mismatch, silent validation, missing confirmation.
P2	Clarity or polish The visitor can proceed; the issue still creates avoidable hesitation or effort. Examples: weak empty state, unclear label, non-critical layout defect.

Severity is a decision aid. It is not a substitute for the evidence on page 6.

YOUR NEXT MOVE

Run it yourself. Or reserve a second pair of eyes.

The free checklist is public. The paid reviews add timestamped evidence, a prioritized issue list, and a short walkthrough.

MINI**\$39 total**

\$19.50 deposit today

1 public journey | 4 checks | initial delivery within 4 hours

FULL**\$89 total**

\$44.50 deposit today

3 public journeys | 12 checks | initial delivery within 12 hours

Free checklist + live offermshafei721.github.io/twelvecheck/

Public, credential-free checks only. No security, compliance, load, or private-system assurance.

Save the guide. Share it with a founder who is close to launch.